

ALEX BAKER

Alex Baker's 46 Sets The Pace

Two quadruple bogeys couldn't stop a round that ranks third among his 45 TEG appearances.

Alex Baker opened round one of TEG 16 with 46 stableford points. It was the best return of the day and the third-best Trophy round of his TEG career. It was also bookended by two acts of open self-sabotage.

The short 2nd produced a quadruple-bogey 7, which he appeared to treat as a rounding error. He took the outright lead in the Trophy twice early on, first through the 3rd and again through the 5th. Then came the golf. Seventeen points across holes 8 to 12.

Thirteen more from 14 to 16, including a birdie at the par-5 15th. His streak of pars and better ended at the 17th, one of the hardest holes on the course, with a double bogey. At the par-5 18th he signed for a 9. A second quadruple bogey, delivered with the serenity of a man who had already done the arithmetic.

Two blow-up holes cost him eight shots against par. The stretches either side were good enough that it did not matter.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY Alex BAKER (46 pts)
TROPHY LEAD Alex BAKER, 12 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD Jon BAKER, 2 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD
AB 46 JP 34 DM 32 GW 31 JB 30
ROUND GROSS
JB +24 AB +26 GW +27 DM +28 JP +30

AFTER R1 • TROPHY
AB 46 JP 34 DM 32 GW 31 JB 30
AFTER R1 • GREEN JACKET
JB +24 AB +26 GW +27 DM +28 JP +30

JON BAKER

Jon Baker Leads Jacket, Props Up Spoon

The best gross card of the day and the worst points return sat on the same scorecard.

Jon Baker's opening round did two different jobs in two different competitions. That is what handicapping is for. On the par-5 5th, a bogey was still enough to move him into the outright lead of the Green Jacket (Gross). By the close of the day his card carried the best gross score of the field,

and he stood at the very top of the Jacket standings after Round 1.

The Stableford column was less generous. Holes 7 to 9 undid him twice over: three holes without a net par, and seven gross shots gone across a double bogey on the par-5 7th, a double on the par-3 8th and a triple on the par-4 9th. A closing

double bogey on the 18th dropped him to the bottom of the Wooden Spoon race. By the end of the day Alex Baker led the Trophy, level on points at the top. Jon Baker sat bottom of the Trophy and bottom of the Spoon, and top of the Jacket. He had, in fairness, gone round in fewer shots than anybody else.

JOHN PATTERSON

John Patterson's Round Of Two Halves

Twenty-two shots lost across seven holes were nearly clawed back in four.

John Patterson's opening round at PGA Catalunya - Tour demonstrated both things golf can do. The quadruple-bogey 8 at the 3rd set the tone. Triples followed at the 4th, 7th and 9th, doubles at the 5th, 6th and 10th. Across holes 3 to 10 he dropped 22 shots. He went seven holes without a single net par. The triple at the 4th sent him to the bottom of the 2025 TEG Wooden Spoon race, which read less as news than as confirmation.

The back nine belonged to somebody else entirely. From the 13th to the 16th he took 13 stableford points. He played the par-4 13th, the hardest hole on the course, and the par-3 14th without dropping a gross shot at all. The nines differed by 14 points. The card finished on 34 stableford points and said nothing whatsoever about the first ten holes.

DAVID MULLIN

An Eleven At The Fifteenth Undoes David Mullin

A previous best of 84 around this course felt a long way off by the time he reached the 15th.

David Mullin's opening round at PGA Catalunya - Tour unravelled at the 15th. A sextuple bogey 11 on the par-5, the worst score he has ever recorded on that hole. Four previous visits to the course had not prepared anyone for it. The card it ruined had twice been good enough to share the lead in the TEG 18 Green Jacket race. A quadruple bogey 8 at the 6th had already removed most of the margin for error.

The 15th settled more than the Jacket. The blow-up dropped Mullin from second to fifth in the TEG 18 Wooden Spoon race, sending him to the bottom of that table. His round here was 16 strokes worse than his last visit, and well short of his prior best gross of 84 at the venue. A card of genuine promise, filed instead under evidence.

GREGG WILLIAMS

Gregg Williams Survives A War Of Attrition

A birdie at the 15th briefly rescued a card wrecked by two quadruple bogeys.

Gregg Williams contrived to play two rounds inside one. He opened by bleeding eight shots over three holes from the 3rd: back-to-back triple bogeys, then a double at the 5th. He did not make a net par in any of them. The par-5 7th then took a quadruple-bogey 9, which ended whatever momentum was still being claimed.

Then, implausibly, he stopped it. A birdie at the 15th closed the bleeding. By the 16th he had drawn level for the outright lead in the TEG Green Jacket (Gross). It did not hold. A bogey at the 14th had already dropped him to the bottom of the TEG Wooden Spoon standings. A second quadruple bogey, at the 17th, confirmed the position. Two blow-up holes, two brief flashes of contention, and a finish at the wrong end of the field.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 18, Round 1

RARE FEATS

— David Mullin runs up an 11 (+6) at the 15th — his career-worst on a par-5